EXECUTIVE TEACHING & DEMO SESSION · 90 MINUTES

Define, design, build: your first agents in Copilot Cowork

One repeatable method, shown five times on insurance problems, then yours to use in the working session that follows.

90 MINUTES

Agenda

Time	Block	Min	Method focus
0:00	Why agents, why now; Why we’re here	5	Conceptual understanding
0:05	Intro to Agentic AI; Skills, Task, Sub-Agents, MCP	5	Conceptual understanding
0:10	Agentic Workflow: Define, Design, and Build	15	All seven decisions
0:25	Demo 1 · Strategic Intelligence Agent	20	Routine (scheduled), narrated slowly
0:45	Demo 2 · Annual report to personal dashboard	15	Pipeline
1:00	Demo 3 · Competitor intelligence scan	15	Fan-out
1:15	Patterns, guardrails, set-up for the working session	5	Choosing a pattern
1:20	Recap and Q&A	10	
Optional	Demo 4 · Stakeholder Intelligence Agent	15	Routine (calendar and email triggers)
Optional	Demo 5 · Board-paper review panel	15	Panel

The proliferation of AI agents

Personal agents

Personal work, research and creation



OpenClaw



Claude Cowork



Genspark



Hermes Agent



Muse

Meta



Dots

OpenAI



Manus



Perplexity Computer

Enterprise agents

Company context and shared workflows



Microsoft Copilot

Cowork / Autopilot*



ChatGPT Work

OpenAI



Claude Cowork

Enterprise



Gemini Enterprise

Google



Agentforce

Salesforce



Glean Agents



ServiceNow Otto

NVIDIA **NemoClaw** — Agent blueprints and runtime controls

Examples span personal and enterprise use. *Autopilot: private preview.

Generative AI and Agentic AI Evolution

The scope of delegation expands from answers to software to knowledge work

2022–2024

Chat + search

ChatGPT moment

Ask questions and find information

ChatGPT: 30 Nov 2022
ChatGPT Search: 31 Oct 2024

2025

Coding agents

Claude Code + Opus 4.5

Inspect a repo, edit code and run tests

Claude Code preview: 24 Feb 2025
Opus 4.5 model: 24 Nov 2025

EARLY 2026

Knowledge work agents



OpenClaw



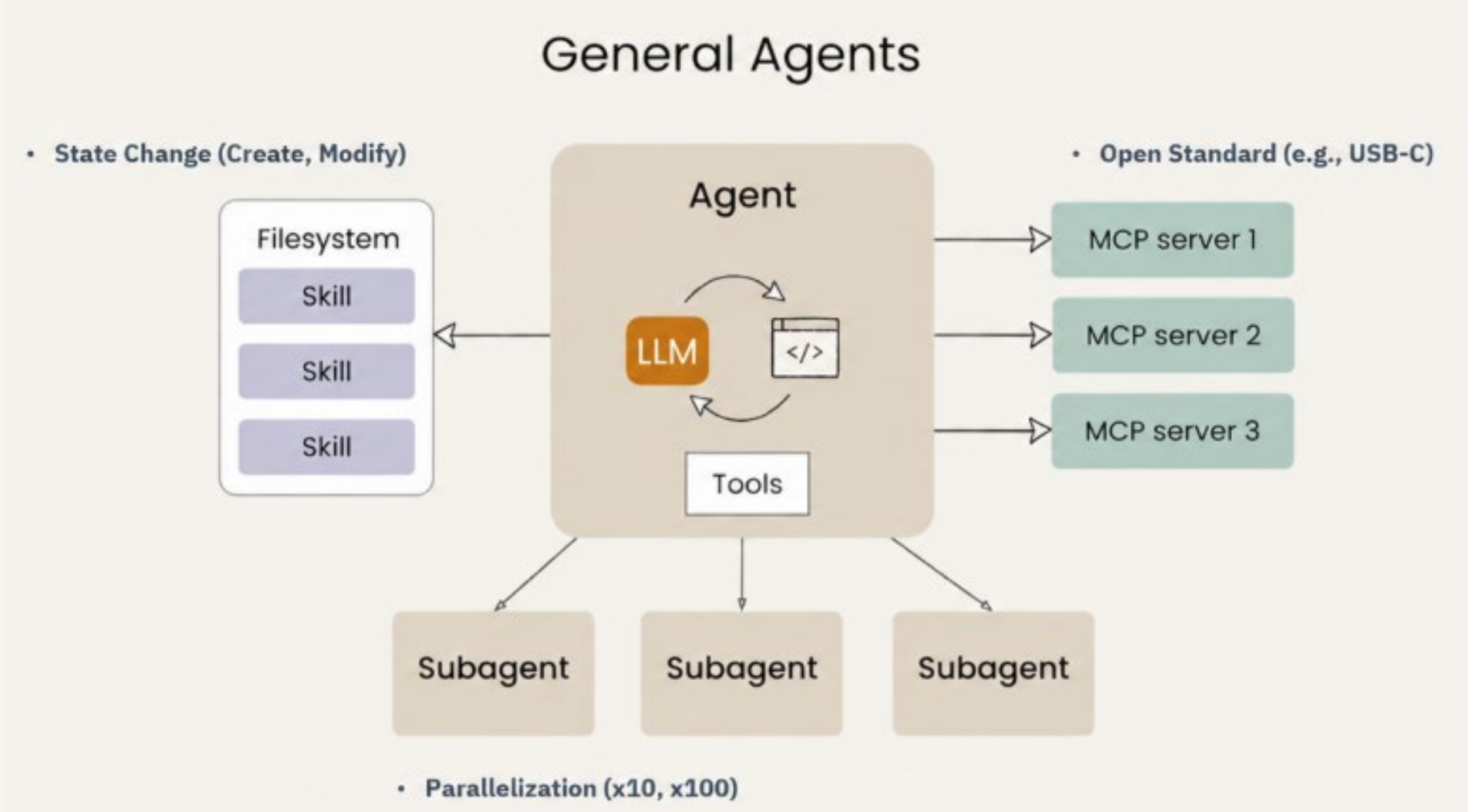
Claude Cowork

Delegate work across files and connected apps

Cowork preview: 12 Jan 2026
OpenClaw rebrand: late Jan 2026

The unit of interaction expands from an answer to a completed task

Agents, Tools, Skills, and MCP (Model Context Protocol)

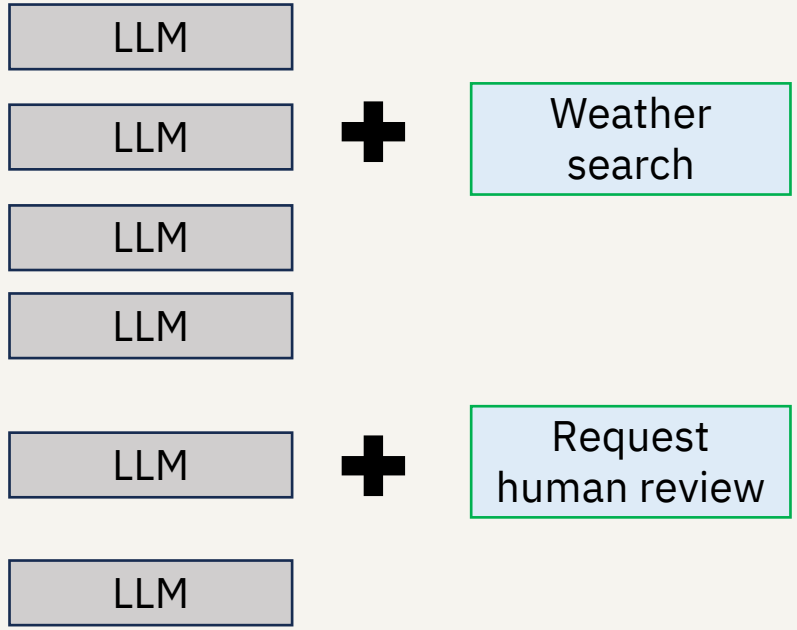


Source: https://learn.deeplearning.ai/courses/agent-skills-with-anthropic

Agentic AI Workflows

An agentic AI workflow is a process where an LLM-based app executes **multiple steps** to **complete a task**

Insurance Claim Settlement Decision Example:



Source: [Agentic AI - DeepLearning.AI]

Agentic AI: Insurance Claim Settlement

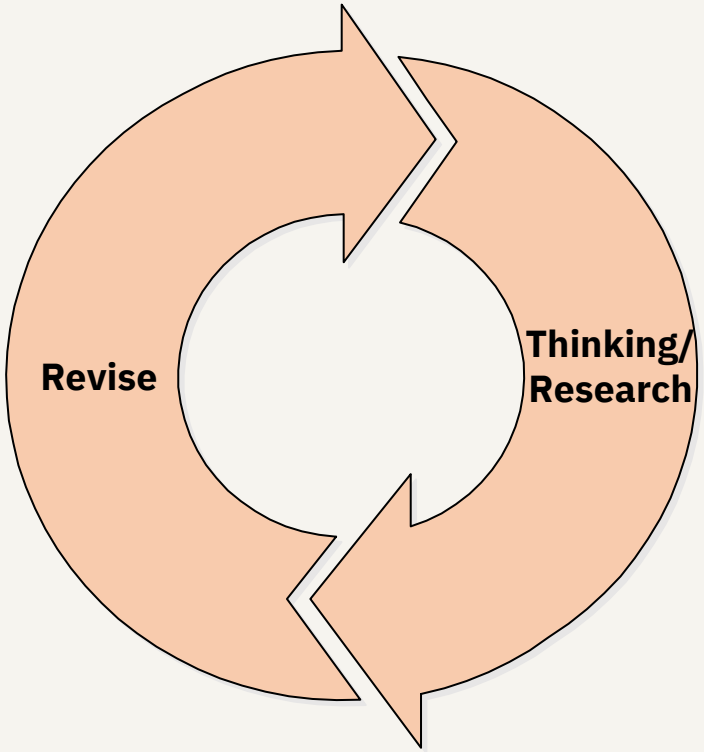
Non-agentic workflow (zero-shot)

Start

Please review this claim and give me a settlement decision.

End

Agentic workflow ("Draft, review & revise")



Extract the key facts from the claim

Do you need a policy or **weather search (tool)**?

Draft a settlement decision

Review and critique the draft

Based on critique, **consider** whether the draft needs revision or a human review

Revise and draft

...

- **Multiple steps** (**parallelization** possible)
- **Reflection loops**
- (Multiple) **tool use**
- Conversational UI

Source: [Agentic AI - DeepLearning.AI]

WHY WE'RE HERE

What you'll leave with

1 · CONCEPTUAL UNDERSTANDING

Why agents, why now

Intro to Agentic AI; Skills, Task, Sub-Agents, MCP

2 · A METHOD

Define → Design → Build

Seven decisions that turn a pain point into a working agent. The same seven every time.

3 · THREE WORKED AGENTS: DEMO

Built live, prompts included

Strategic radar, stakeholder brief, annual-report dashboard, Board-paper review panel, competitor scan.

4 · A CANVAS

Ready for the working session

You'll fill one canvas for your own area and run its first prompt in Cowork straight after this.

THE METHOD

Define → Design → Build: seven decisions

DEFINE (PROBLEM)

1 · Task

Whose decision gets better? What is painful today?

2 · Success

What does good look like, and when must it land?

DESIGN

3 · Sources

Where do the relevant facts live?

4 · Skills

Which built-in skills? What know-how must be written down?

5 · Design Pattern

Single pass, routine, pipeline, fan-out or panel?

6 · Outputs & gates

What format, for whom, and what needs my OK?

BUILD

7 · Build loop

Prompt → run → refine → save as skill → automate → share

1–2 · DEFINE

Name the recipient, the decision, cadence, and “measurable” success

FOUR ELEMENTS OF PROBLEM DEFINITION

A **named recipient**: whose decision gets better?
A **decision** it improves, not just information
A **cadence** or **trigger**: when must it land?
A **measurable “success”**: minutes saved, nothing missed

WEAK TASK DEFINITION

“Keep me informed about the market.”

STRONG TASK DEFINITION

“Every Monday at 7am, give the Group Executive a one-page email of the five developments from the last seven days most likely to move our FY27 priorities, each with a ‘so what’ and a suggested owner.”

3–6 · DESIGN

Four choices before you write a word

3 · SOURCES

Name where the facts live; don't let the agent guess.

Example: APRA and ASIC releases, ASX announcements, the #pricing channel, last month's Board papers

4 · SKILLS

Built-in skills do the mechanics; a custom skill holds your know-how.

Example: strategic-radar: our five priorities, a scoring rubric and our house format

5 · DESIGN PATTERN

Decide how the work is split (next slide).

Example: Five lenses scanned separately, then ranked together

6 · OUTPUTS & GATES

Choose the format, the destination and what needs your OK.

Example: An email to me first; the ELT list only after I approve

5 · PATTERN

Five ways to split the work

Design Pattern	Shape	Use it when	Today
Single pass	one prompt → one output	The job fits in one read and one write	Where every agent starts
Routine	trigger → run → deliver	It must happen on a cadence or when something arrives	Demos 1 and 2
Pipeline	A → file → B → file → C	The source is too big for one pass, or steps depend on each other	Demo 3
Fan-out	same brief × N → synthesis	Independent pieces need identical treatment	Demo 5
Panel	lenses → challenge → verdict	You want disagreement surfaced, not consensus	Demo 4

7 · BUILD

Every prompt has six parts

Role	Who it is working as
Goal	The outcome, in one sentence
Sources	Exactly where to look, and the time window
Steps	The order of work; what to judge and how
Output	Format, name, destination
Guardrails	What it must not do; what to flag

ROLE: You are my chief-of-staff.

GOAL: Prepare me for Thursday's meeting with [Name], CEO of [Broker].

SOURCES: Last 90 days of email, Teams chats and recaps with [Broker]; SharePoint › Partners; their news.

STEPS: Priorities → commitments (both sides) → risks → three asks for me.

OUTPUT: 1-page Word brief + rows in commitments-tracker

GUARDRAILS: Cite a source for every commitment. Don't contact anyone.

7 · BUILD

The build ladder: from one prompt to a routine

1 · Prompt once
Run it by hand and read the result

→

2 · Refine
Correct it in the same task until it's right

→

3 · Save as skill
Customize › Skills, or 'turn this into a skill'

→

4 · Automate
A scheduled prompt or an event trigger

→

5 · Share
Share the skill with named colleagues

Rule of three: run it by hand three times before you automate it.

HOW TO WATCH THE DEMOS

Every demo follows the same five beats

1 min	2 min	3 min	3 min	2 min
1 · Define	**2 · Design**	**3 · Build**	**4 · Review**	**5 · Harden**
Canvas: task and success	Sources, skills, pattern, gates	Paste the prompt, watch the plan	Open and check the outputs	Save the skill, set the trigger

Watch the beats, not the buttons. You’ll use the same five in the working session. session.

FIVE DEMOS

Five agents, one method

#	Agent	Business problem	Pattern	Main output
1	**Strategic Intelligence**	**Signals scattered across market, competitors, tech, regulators and inside**	**Routine**	**Weekly email brief**
2	**Annual-report dashboard**	**200 pages; each leader needs different numbers**	**Pipeline**	**Summary + role dashboard**
3	**Competitor scan**	**No like-for-like view of four competitors**	**Fan-out**	**Profiles + matrix + slides**
4	Stakeholder Intelligence	Critical meetings without one view of the stakeholder	Routine	Brief + commitments tracker
5	Board-paper review panel	Papers reach the Board with avoidable gaps	Panel	Critique + conflict log

DEMO 1 OF 5 · ROUTINE · BEATS 1–2

Strategic Intelligence Agent

DEFINE · 1 · TASK

The Group Executive can't keep across market, competitor, technology, regulatory and internal signals, or tell which ones touch FY27 priorities.

DEFINE · 2 · SUCCESS

A Monday 7am email: the top five signals from the last seven days, each with a ‘so what’ and an owner. Read in five minutes.

DESIGN · 3 · SOURCES

Web: APRA, ASIC, Treasury, AFCA, ASX releases, industry news · Plugins such as LSEG or Moody's, if licensed · Internal: strategy on a page, Board papers, Teams channels

DESIGN · 4 · SKILLS

Built-in: Deep Research, Enterprise Search, Email, Word · Custom: strategic-radar (priorities, sources, scoring rubric, format)

DESIGN · 5 · PATTERN

Routine: a weekly scheduled prompt. Inside each run, five lenses are scanned separately, then ranked together.

DESIGN · 6 · OUTPUTS & GATES

An email brief plus a Word copy in SharePoint. It comes to me first; the ELT list only after I approve.

DEMO 1 · WORKFLOW

One weekly run, from trigger to inbox

Schedule fires
Monday 6:30am, Sydney time

→

Load skill
Priorities, sources and scoring rubric

→

SCAN 5 LENSES

- **Market & customer**
- **Competitors**
- **Technology**
- **Regulatory**
- **Internal**

→

Score & rank
Impact × urgency against each priority

→

Draft
Email brief + Word archive

→

You approve
Then it goes to the ELT

SKILL = KNOW-HOW
Priorities and rubric live in the skill, so the weekly prompt is one line.

SCHEDULE = TIMING
Scheduled runs start fresh, so the skill must carry everything.

APPROVAL = CONTROL
Nothing leaves your mailbox until you say so.

DEMO 1 · BEAT 3 · BUILD PROMPT

First run: brief it like a new chief-of-staff

You are my strategy chief-of-staff at [Insurer], an Australian general insurer.

GOAL: Each week, find the 5 developments from the last 7 days most likely to affect our FY27 priorities.

CONTEXT: Read "FY27 Strategy on a Page.docx" (SharePoint › Strategy) first. Those are the priorities.

SOURCES: Scan five lenses separately:
1 Market & customer: affordability, premium trends, natural-hazard events, broker moves
2 Competitors: Suncorp, Budget Direct, Youi, Allianz Australia
3 Technology: AI in claims, pricing and underwriting; core-platform and vendor news
4 Regulatory: APRA, ASIC, Treasury, AFCA, Insurance Council (consultations, speeches, enforcement)
5 Internal: my email, Teams channels #strategy and #pricing, Board papers from the last 7 days

STEPS: For each signal: one-line summary, date, link. Rate impact on each priority (H/M/L) and urgency.
Keep the top 5; list the next 5 as a watchlist.

OUTPUT: Email to me, subject "Strategic Radar – w/c [date]": 3-line headline; top 5 as What happened · So what for us · Suggested owner · Source; watchlist; 3 questions for the ELT.
Save a Word copy to Documents/Cowork/Radar/.

GUARDRAILS: Only items dated in the last 7 days. Link every claim. Say "no material change" rather than pad. Draft only: send to no one but me.

DEMO 1 · BEAT 5 · HARDEN

Save the know-how as a skill, then schedule it

```
---
name: strategic-radar
description: Weekly strategic radar for the ELT. Use when
  asked for the radar, a strategy scan or what changed.
---
## Priorities [replace with ours, review quarterly]
1 Motor & home margins · 2 Natural-hazard pricing
3 Claims cost · 4 Digital & AI · 5 Regulatory standing

## Always check
APRA, ASIC, Treasury, AFCA, Insurance Council, ASX

## Scoring
Impact on a priority (H/M/L) × urgency (now/qtr/watch)

## Format
Headline · Top 5 (What · So what · Owner · Source)
· Watchlist · 3 questions for the ELT
```

AUTOMATE · SCHEDULED PROMPT

"Run the strategic-radar skill every Monday at 6:30am Sydney time and email me the result. Ask me before sending to anyone else."

Manage it later under Automations › Manage schedules.

POINT OUT

The weekly prompt is now one line; the skill carries the rest.

After three good weeks, approve sending to the ELT list.

DEMO 2 OF 5 · PIPELINE · BEATS 1–2

Annual report to personal dashboard

DEFINE · 1 · TASK

A 200-page annual report, ours or a peer's, and every leader needs a different handful of numbers from it.

DEFINE · 2 · SUCCESS

Within 30 minutes: a verified KPI table, trends and anomalies, a one-page summary, and a dashboard for my role. Every figure has a page number.

DESIGN · 3 · SOURCES

annual-report.pdf (FY26) · last year's report (optional) · our KPI definitions

DESIGN · 4 · SKILLS

Built-in: PDF, Excel, Word, App · Custom: insurance-kpis (GWP, insurance revenue, claims and expense ratios, COR, ITR, capital)

DESIGN · 5 · PATTERN

Pipeline: three sequential sub-agents, each reading only the previous file. Small contexts, an auditable trail.

DESIGN · 6 · OUTPUTS & GATES

financials.md → trends.md → exec-summary.md → role dashboard (App or Excel). Nothing is sent; I check the numbers.

DEMO 2 · WORKFLOW

Three stages, handed off through files

Annual report
annual-report.pdf, about 200 pages

→

1 · Extract
financials.md: every figure with its page

→

2 · Analyse
trends.md: YoY, vs guidance, anomalies

→

3 · Summarise
exec-summary.md: one page for the Board

→

You verify, then personalise
Spot-check 3 figures; dashboard for your role

SMALL CONTEXTS
Each stage reads one file, not 200 pages plus a conversation.

AUDIT TRAIL
Every number traces to a page; calculations are marked.

RE-RUN ONE STAGE
Change the summary without re-extracting.

DEMO 2 · BEAT 3 · BUILD PROMPT

Extract → analyse → summarise

Process our FY26 annual report (annual-report.pdf) in 3 sequential sub-agents to avoid filling the context window. Each sub-agent reads only the file named. Save files to Documents/Cowork/AR-FY26/.

SUB-AGENT 1: Extract all financial figures and KPIs, with page numbers → financials.md
Cover GWP, insurance revenue, net claims ratio, expense ratio, combined ratio (COR), insurance trading ratio (ITR), reserve releases, natural-hazard cost vs allowance, reinsurance expense, investment income, NPAT, ROE, capital (PCA coverage or CET1) and dividend. This year and last, by segment where reported.

SUB-AGENT 2: (reads financials.md) Identify YoY trends, results vs guidance, and anomalies → trends.md
e.g. a claims ratio that improved while natural-hazard costs rose; one-offs; restated figures.

SUB-AGENT 3: (reads trends.md) Write a 1-page executive summary for the Board → exec-summary.md
5 headlines, 3 risks, 3 questions management should answer.

RULES: Every number carries its page reference. Mark anything you calculated "calc". If a figure isn't in the report, write "not disclosed". Don't round away movements under 0.5 points.

DEMO 2 · BEAT 5 · PERSONALISE

One pipeline, a dashboard for each role

Role	The dashboard shows
CEO	Five headlines, progress on strategy, peer comparison, questions for the Board
CFO	NPAT, ROE, capital position, investment income, dividend, reserve releases
Chief Underwriting Officer	COR and ITR by segment; attritional vs natural-hazard claims; rate vs exposure
Chief Claims Officer	Claims ratio drivers, natural-hazard costs vs allowance, claims handling expense

```
Using financials.md and trends.md, build me a one-screen dashboard for a Chief Underwriting Officer: COR and ITR by segment over 2 years; claims split into attritional, natural hazard and reserve releases; top 3 anomalies with page links. Build it with the App skill; save the table to Excel.
```

Harden: save the KPI definitions as the **insurance-kpis** skill so every dashboard uses the same definitions.

DEMO 2 · BEAT 5 · HARDEN

Extract → analyse → summarize → dashboard (1/2)

Process our FY26 annual report (annual-report.pdf) in 4 sequential sub-agents to avoid filling the context window. Each sub-agent reads only its assigned input file(s). Complete and save each stage before starting the next. Save all files to Documents/Cowork/AR-FY26/.

SUB-AGENT 1 — Extract financial figures
Reads: annual-report.pdf
Output: financials.md
Extract all financial figures and KPIs, with page numbers.
Cover GWP, insurance revenue, net claims ratio, expense ratio, combined ratio (COR), insurance trading ratio (ITR), reserve releases, natural-hazard cost vs allowance, reinsurance expense, investment income, NPAT, ROE, capital (PCA coverage or CET1) and dividend. Include this year and last, by segment where reported.
Organize the figures into structured tables. Preserve each metric's reported name and definition, reporting period, segment, currency, unit, page reference and any restatement notes. Include disclosed guidance, allowances and capital target ranges needed for subsequent comparisons. Record both the printed report page and the PDF page index when they differ.

SUB-AGENT 2 — Analyze trends and anomalies
Reads: financials.md
Output: trends.md
Identify YoY trends, results vs guidance, and anomalies—for example, a claims ratio that improved while natural-hazard costs rose; one-offs; restated figures.
Include supporting figures and page references for each finding. Show formulas and input values for calculations. Distinguish explanations stated in the report from your interpretations. Preserve enough numerical evidence and source detail for the executive summary and dashboard.

SUB-AGENT 3 — Write the executive summary
Reads: trends.md
Output: exec-summary.md
Write a 1-page executive summary for the Board:
5 headlines.
3 risks.
3 questions management should answer.
Retain source page references for all numerical claims. Prioritize findings that affect profitability, underwriting performance, capital strength and management decisions.

DEMO 2 · BEAT 5 · HARDEN

Extract → analyse → summarize → dashboard (2/2)

SUB-AGENT 4 — Create the dashboard
Reads: financials.md, trends.md and exec-summary.md
Output: dashboard.html
Create a professional, interactive dashboard for the Board. Deliver one self-contained HTML file with embedded CSS, JavaScript and data. It must open locally in a browser without installation, a server or an internet connection.
Include the following sections:
Executive snapshot: KPI cards for key reported metrics, including GWP, insurance revenue, NPAT, COR/ITR, ROE, capital coverage and dividend. Show this year, last year and the change, with clear units and source page references.
Financial and underwriting performance: Charts comparing the two years for revenue, profit, claims ratio, expense ratio and combined ratio. Keep monetary values and ratios on clearly separated scales. Show natural-hazard cost vs allowance, results vs guidance, and capital vs disclosed targets where comparable figures are available.
Segment comparison: A table and suitable charts comparing reported business segments. Add a segment filter that updates the relevant cards, charts and tables consistently. Clearly identify metrics available only at group level.
Board insights: Display the 5 headlines, 3 risks and 3 management questions from exec-summary.md. Include relevant trends and anomalies from trends.md, with supporting evidence.
Evidence explorer: A searchable, sortable table containing metric, period, segment, value, unit, report page and reported/calculated status. For calculated values, expose the formula and source inputs. Provide clickable PDF page links only when the correct PDF page index and accessible file location are known.
Export and presentation: Include a button to download the displayed data as CSV and a clean print layout suitable for saving as PDF.
Use a restrained, professional design with readable typography, accessible contrast, responsive layouts and clear chart labels. Display the report title and reporting period prominently. Explain whether increases or decreases are favorable only when the metric's meaning supports that interpretation.

RULES
Every number carries its page reference, including numbers in summaries, cards, charts and tables.
Mark anything you calculated "calc" and show the formula and source inputs.
If a figure is not in the report, write "not disclosed." Do not substitute zero, estimate a missing value or fabricate guidance.
Distinguish percentage growth from percentage-point changes in ratios. Preserve the reported units for capital multiples and other measures.
Do not round away movements under 0.5 points or imply precision beyond the source figures.
Use comparable reporting periods and definitions. Clearly flag restatements, one-offs and changes in segment boundaries.
Do not invent target ranges, risk thresholds or explanations for observed changes.
Before delivery, reconcile the dashboard against financials.md and trends.md. Verify that filters, source references, CSV export and print layout work correctly.

DEMO 3 OF 5 · FAN-OUT · BEATS 1–2

Competitor intelligence scan

DEFINE · 1 · TASK

Before the strategy offsite we need a like-for-like view of IAG + our four main competitors, not four differently shaped reports.

DEFINE · 2 · SUCCESS

Five profiles with identical headings, every fact dated and sourced, plus a differentiator summary. Refreshed after each reporting season.

DESIGN · 3 · SOURCES

Web: ASX announcements, results presentations, investor centres, product pages · ProductReview.com.au, Google, Trustpilot · AFCA complaint data · rating data via plugins

DESIGN · 4 · SKILLS

Built-in: Deep Research, Excel, Word, PowerPoint · Custom: competitor-profile (headings, source rules)

DESIGN · 5 · PATTERN

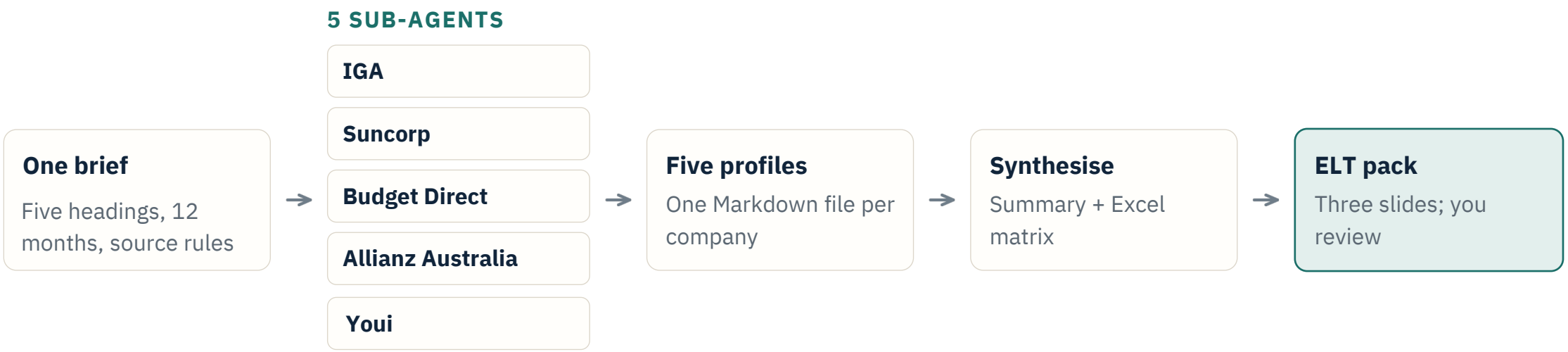
Fan-out: five parallel sub-agents on the same brief, then one synthesis.

DESIGN · 6 · OUTPUTS & GATES

One profile per company · research/summary.md · competitor-matrix.xlsx · three slides for the ELT

DEMO 3 · WORKFLOW

Same brief four times, then synthesise



IDENTICAL BRIEFS

Identical headings make the profiles comparable.

SPEED

Four pieces of independent research run side by side.

INSIGHT IS IN THE SYNTHESIS

Differentiators and implications only appear when compared.

DEMO 3 · BEAT 3 · BUILD PROMPT

Four researchers, one brief

Research these 5 competitors in parallel, using a separate sub-agent for each and the same brief.
Sub-agent 1: IAG · Sub-agent 2: Suncorp
Sub-agent 3: Budget Direct · Sub-agent 4: Allianz Australia· Sub-agent 5: Youi

BRIEF: Australian business, last 12 months, under these exact headings:
1 Results & outlook: GWP growth, insurance trading ratio or COR, guidance, capital position
2 Pricing & affordability: premium rate moves by line, public statements, affordability steps
3 Product & digital: launches, channels, partnerships, AI and claims initiatives
4 Customer voice: themes from ProductReview.com.au, Google and Trustpilot, AFCA complaint data
5 Corporate moves: M&A, reinsurance program, leadership changes, regulatory action

RULES: Cite and date every fact. Prefer company filings to media. Flag anything older than 12 months.

SAVE: Each profile to research/{company}.md.

SYNTHESIS: Once all 5 finish, write research/summary.md: a side-by-side table, 5 key differentiators, where each is gaining or losing ground, and 3 implications for [Insurer]. Also build research/competitor-matrix.xlsx.

DEMO 3 · BEAT 5 · HARDEN

Turn the research into a pack, then a routine

NEXT PROMPT · THE ELT PACK

“Turn research/summary.md into 3 slides for the ELT: the landscape, the differentiators, and the implications for us. Use our PowerPoint template.”

AUTOMATE · AFTER EACH REPORTING SEASON

“In early March and early September, rerun the competitor-profile brief and highlight what changed since the last summary.”

SAVE AS SKILL

competitor-profile: the five headings, the 12-month window, the source rules. Reuse it for brokers, reinsurers or vendors.

BEFORE IT REACHES THE ELT

Spot-check three facts per profile. Web research is only as good as its sources.

RECAP

Choosing the pattern

If the work…	Use	Build tip
Fits in one read and one write	Single pass	Start here; most agents begin as one prompt
Must happen on a cadence, or when something arrives	Routine	Write the prompt as if Cowork has never seen it
Is too big for one pass, or steps depend on each other	Pipeline	Hand off through files; re-run one stage at a time
Has independent pieces needing the same treatment	Fan-out	Identical briefs and headings, then synthesise
Needs challenge more than agreement	Panel	Give each reviewer a distinct lens; log conflicts

RECAP

How sources, skills and outputs combine

Agent	Trigger	Sources	Custom skill	Outputs
1 Strategic radar	Weekly schedule	Web, plugins, SharePoint, Teams, email	strategic-radar	Email + Word
2 Stakeholder brief	Calendar; inbound email	Calendar, email, Teams, recaps, CRM, web	stakeholder-brief	Word, Excel tracker, email draft
3 Report dashboard	On demand	Annual report PDF	insurance-kpis	3 Markdown files, app or Excel
4 Board-paper panel	On demand	Paper PDF, template, model	board-paper-standard	Critique, conflict log, Word
5 Competitor scan	Each reporting season	Web, reviews, AFCA data, plugins	competitor-profile	Profiles, Excel, PowerPoint

LEADING SAFELY

Six guardrails for executives

1

It sees what you see

Runs with your Microsoft 365 permissions and sensitivity labels. It can't open encrypted files.

2

It asks before it acts

Sends, posts and invites wait for approval. Keep approvals on for anything external.

3

You own the output

Demand sources and page numbers. Spot-check three facts before you forward anything.

4

Treat skills like policy

They run as instructions in your name. Use trusted authors; review before sharing.

5

Regulated calls stay human

Pricing, claims and customer outcomes: the agent drafts, an accountable person decides.

6

Usage has a cost

Billed by usage in Copilot Credits; admins set limits. Long runs cost more.

MAKING IT RELIABLE

Five habits of good agent builders

Brief once, up front	Attach everything at the start. Keep one job per task; if a long thread drifts, ask for a hand-off summary and start a fresh task.
Name your sources	“Search everything” is slow and noisy. “These five sites and this folder” is fast and checkable.
Hand off through files	Pipelines and fan-outs then work whether Cowork runs steps in parallel or in turn, and leave an audit trail.
Let long jobs run	Tasks take minutes. Start one, get on with your day, come back to the Output folder.
Rehearse in your tenant	Plugins, web access and preview features vary by licence and region. Test before you promise.

YOUR TURN

The Agent Canvas

DEFINE · 1 PROBELM

Whose decision gets better? What's painful today?

DEFINE · 2 SUCCESS

What does good look like? When must it land?

DESIGN · 3 SOURCES

Where do the facts live? Name them.

DESIGN · 4 SKILLS

Built-in skills? What know-how must be written down?

DESIGN · 5 PATTERN

Single, routine, pipeline, fan-out or panel?

DESIGN · 6 OUTPUTS & GATES

Format, reader, and what needs my OK?

BUILD · 7 FIRST PROMPT

Role · Goal · Sources · Steps · Output · Guardrails

NEXT

What happens in the working session

1 · Pick
One recurring task from your area that costs you time every week

→

2 · Canvas
Fill boxes 1–6 in pairs; challenge each other's 'Done'

→

3 · Build
Write the six-part prompt and run it in Cowork

→

4 · Share
One output, one surprise, one next step

Suggested timings: 10 · 15 · 20 · 10 minutes. Adjust to your session length.

BRING

A real recurring task · access to Cowork · one document you're allowed to use

LEAVE WITH

A filled canvas · a working first prompt · a date to run it three more times

Appendix

DEMO 4 OF 5 · ROUTINE · BEATS 1–2

Stakeholder Intelligence Agent

DEFINE · 1 · TASK

Leaders walk into Board, regulator, broker and reinsurer meetings without one view of the stakeholder's priorities, promises and concerns.

DEFINE · 2 · SUCCESS

A brief in my inbox the day before every key meeting. Prep drops from an hour to ten minutes. No missed commitments.

DESIGN · 3 · SOURCES

The calendar invite and attendees · 90 days of email, Teams chats and meeting recaps · SharePoint account files · CRM via Dynamics 365 · their public news

DESIGN · 4 · SKILLS

Built-in: Meetings, Enterprise Search, Word, Excel, Email · Custom: stakeholder-brief (format, what counts as a commitment, temperature scale)

DESIGN · 5 · PATTERN

Routine: a daily calendar check, plus an email-triggered update whenever the stakeholder writes.

DESIGN · 6 · OUTPUTS & GATES

One-page Word brief · a rolling commitments tracker in Excel · a follow-up email draft, sent only after I approve.

DEMO 4 · WORKFLOW

Before the meeting, and after it

Daily, 7am
Check tomorrow's calendar

→

Filter
External attendees on the key stakeholder list

→

GATHER

Email & Teams, 90 days

Meeting recaps

SharePoint & CRM

Public news

→

Profile
Priorities, concerns, commitments, temperature

→

Deliver
Word brief + tracker rows

→

After the meeting
Follow-up draft; you approve

THE CALENDAR IS THE TRIGGER
You never ask for the brief; the meeting does.

TWO OUTPUTS
One to read today (the brief), one that builds up (the tracker).

SAME PERMISSIONS AS YOU
It sees only mail, chats and files you can already open.

DEMO 4 · BEAT 3 · BUILD PROMPT

First run: one meeting, one brief

You are my chief-of-staff. Prepare me for my meeting with [Name], [Role] at [Organization], on [date].

GOAL: Walk in knowing what they care about, what each side has promised, and what could go wrong.

SOURCES: The invite and attendee list; my email, Teams chats and meeting recaps with anyone from [Organization] in the last 90 days; SharePoint › Partners › [Organisation]; their public news.

STEPS:

1 Their top 3 priorities and concerns, each with evidence.
2 Every commitment by us or by them: what, owner, due date, status (done/open/overdue), source.
3 Relationship temperature (warming / steady / cooling) and why.
4 Sensitive topics to handle with care, and 3 asks I should make.

OUTPUT: A 1-page Word brief, "Stakeholder Brief – [Name] – [date]".
Add each open commitment as a row in Documents/Cowork/Stakeholders/commitments-tracker.xlsx (stakeholder, commitment, owner, due, status, source).

GUARDRAILS: Cite a source for every commitment. Mark anything older than 60 days "check still current".
Don't contact anyone.

DEMO 4 · BEAT 5 · HARDEN

One skill, three ways to trigger it

```
---
name: stakeholder-brief
description: One-page brief before a meeting with a
  stakeholder. Use for "prep me for" or "brief me on".
---
## Commitments
A dated promise with an owner, made in email, chat
or a meeting. Track both sides.
## Temperature
Warming / steady / cooling. Always give the reason.
## Format
Snapshot · Priorities & concerns · Commitments table
· Temperature · Handle with care · 3 asks
```

SCHEDULED

“Every weekday at 7am, check tomorrow's calendar. For each meeting with someone on key-stakeholders.xlsx, run stakeholder-brief and email me the brief.”

EVENT-DRIVEN

“Whenever I receive an email from @[broker domain], check it against the commitments tracker, update statuses and flag anything new.”

ON DEMAND, AFTER THE MEETING

“Draft a follow-up for the meeting I just had with [Name]: decisions, actions, owners, dates. Leave it for my approval.”

DEMO 5 OF 5 · PANEL · BEATS 1–2

Board-paper review panel

DEFINE · 1 · TASK

Board papers reach the Board with gaps a sceptical director will find: an unclear ask, unsupported numbers, unaddressed risks.

DEFINE · 2 · SUCCESS

Before the paper goes to the CEO: a verdict, the top five fixes and a log of where reviewers disagree, in about 20 minutes.

DESIGN · 3 · SOURCES

board-paper.pdf · our Board-paper template and risk appetite statement (SharePoint) · the business-case model (Excel)

DESIGN · 4 · SKILLS

Built-in: PDF, Word, Excel · Custom: board-paper-standard (our template, decision box, risk language)

DESIGN · 5 · PATTERN

Panel: three reviewers with different lenses, then a challenge round that logs conflicts.

DESIGN · 6 · OUTPUTS & GATES

One notes file per reviewer · output/board-paper-review.md · optional Word copy with comments. Author only; nothing shared.

DEMO 5 · WORKFLOW

Three lenses, one challenge round, one verdict

Board paper
board-paper.pdf, template, risk appetite

→

3 REVIEWERS

Narrative · Board lens

Numbers · CFO & Actuary

Devil's advocate · sceptical director

→

Challenge round
Conflicts logged: view A vs view B

→

Consolidate
Verdict, top 5 fixes, page comments

→

Author revises
Before it goes to the CEO

DISAGREEMENT IS THE PRODUCT
Read the conflict log first; that's where the value is.

SEED THE TEST
Plant two unsupported claims in the demo paper and watch the panel find them.

TIMING
Run it before the paper reaches the CEO, not after.

DEMO 5 · BEAT 3 · BUILD PROMPT

A review panel that argues with itself

Create a review panel for our Board paper on AI-enabled claims transformation (board-paper.pdf).
Spawn three reviewers. Each works from its own brief and writes its own notes file:

NARRATIVE: Board lens. Is the decision sought clear on page 1? Does it flow problem → options → recommendation → risks → ask? Could a non-executive director follow it in 10 min? → review/narrative.md

NUMBERS: CFO and Appointed Actuary lens. Fact-check every figure and claim. Test the benefits case (leakage, cycle time, expense ratio, payback): baselines, assumptions, sensitivities. → review/numbers.md

DEVIL'S ADVOCATE: Skeptical director. Argue why the Board should decline or defer. Be harsh: delivery risk, customer outcomes and claims-handling duties, APRA CPS 230 and CPS 234, model risk, vendor lock-in, workforce impact. → review/devils-advocate.md

CONFLICTS: Have reviewers message each other where they disagree (e.g. the narrative claims a benefit the numbers reviewer finds unsupported). Record both views and a proposed resolution.

OUTPUT: output/board-paper-review.md: verdict (Ready / Ready with changes / Not ready), top 5 fixes, conflict log (issue · view A · view B · resolution), page-referenced comments.

GUARDRAILS: Critique only. Don't rewrite the paper or share it with anyone.

APPENDIX · FOR BUILDERS

Skill template and limits

```
---
name: [skill-name]
description: [What it does]. Use when [trigger phrases].

---
## Purpose
[Who it serves and the decision it improves]
## Inputs
[Sources to always use; time window]
## Steps
[Ordered steps; how to judge or score]
## Output format
[Sections, length, file name, destination]
## Rules
[Must-dos and must-nots; what to flag]
```

WHERE SKILLS LIVE

OneDrive › Documents/Cowork/skills/[name]/SKILL.md, or create one on the Customize page › Skills

LIMITS

Up to 50 custom skills per person · SKILL.md up to 1 MB · up to 20 companion files, 10 MB per skill · up to 25 scheduled prompts

WHY SKILLS FAIL

A vague description (never fires) · too broad (fires wrongly) · two skills competing for the same trigger

THE METHOD, IN ONE LINE

Define the task.
Design the parts.
Build, then harden.

Run it by hand three times. Then make it a skill. Then let it run.

WHY AGENTS, WHY NOW

From asking to delegating

	Copilot Chat	Copilot Cowork
You give it	A question	An outcome to deliver
It does	Answers in seconds	Plans steps, works for minutes, checks in with you
It looks at	What you paste or point to	Your email, Teams, calendar and files, the web, and plugins
You get back	Text in a chat	Word, Excel, PowerPoint, PDF, email drafts and apps, saved to OneDrive
It runs	When you ask	On demand, on a schedule, or when an email or Teams message arrives
You control	What you copy and paste	Every send, post and meeting invite, through approvals

Source: Microsoft Learn, Copilot Cowork overview and FAQ.

Summary: Prompts, Skills, Subagents, and MCP

Feature	Prompts	Skills	Subagents	MCP
What it provides	Moment-to-moment instruction	Procedural knowledge	Task delegation	Tool connectivity
Persistence	Single conversation	Across conversations	Across sessions	Continuous connection
Contains	Natural language	Instructions + code + assets	Full agent logic	Tool definitions
When it loads	Each turn	Dynamically, as needed	When invoked	Always available
Best for	Quick requests (one time)	Specialized expertise	Specialized tasks	Data access

Source: https://learn.deeplearning.ai/courses/agent-skills-with-anthropic ; Skills explained: How Skills compares to prompts, Projects, MCP, and subagents | Claude by Anthropic
The-Complete-Guide-to-Building-Skill-for-Claude.pdf

HOW COWORK FITS TOGETHER

Every agent has the same parts

SOURCES

Work IQ (Outlook, Teams, calendar, SharePoint), the web, plugins

SKILLS

Built-in: Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Email, Deep Research… Custom: your know-how in a SKILL.md

INSTRUCTIONS

Role, goal, sources, steps, output, guardrails

→

Cowork

Breaks the goal into steps

Works through them with a visible progress log

Asks when something is unclear

Pauses before anything leaves your hands

→

OUTPUTS

Word, Excel, PowerPoint, PDF · email drafts · Markdown files · interactive apps · all saved to OneDrive › Cowork

When: on demand · on a schedule · on an email or Teams message

Guardrails: your permissions · approval before send, post, invite

APPENDIX · FOR BUILDERS

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
Skill doesn't load	Vague description, no trigger words	Rewrite the description; call the skill by name
Format drifts between runs	Format only in the prompt	Put the format, with an example, in the skill
Wrong or unsourced numbers	No page-reference rule	Require page refs and 'calc' flags; ask for a verification pass
Scheduled run is weak	Prompt relies on the old chat	Make the prompt standalone: sources, dates, format
Web source fails	Sign-in or site blocks access	Complete the sign-in when asked, or attach the PDF
Run takes too long	One huge step	Split into a pipeline; narrow the sources

APPENDIX

Sources

- Copilot Cowork overview – Microsoft Learn
- Use Copilot Cowork – Microsoft Learn
- Copilot Cowork common questions – Microsoft Learn
- Copilot Cowork is now generally available – Microsoft 365 Blog
- Copilot Cowork: skills, integrations and devices – Microsoft 365 Blog
- ASIC sets 2026 priorities impacting insurance – Insurance Business Australia

- Cowork for personal accounts (Preview) – Microsoft Support
- Manage Copilot Cowork for your organization – Microsoft Learn
- Available plugins for Cowork – Microsoft Learn
- Microsoft 365 Copilot business pricing
- Copilot Cowork common questions – Microsoft Learn
- Copilot Developer Camp: Cowork setup